

New LPE vulnerabilities allow full root access on major distributions

Two newly identified local privilege escalation (LPE) vulnerabilities can allow attackers to gain full root access on systems running major Linux distributions.

The first vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2025-6018, affects the configuration of the Pluggable Authentication Modules (PAM) framework in openSUSE Leap 15 and SUSE Linux Enterprise 15. It allows local users to escalate privileges by impersonating the 'allow_active' user.

The second flaw, CVE-2025-6019, exists in libblockdev and can be exploited by an 'allow_active' user to obtain root privileges via the udisks daemon—a storage management service that runs by default on most Linux systems.

Used together in a chained local-to-root exploit, these flaws enable a quick and complete system takeover. However, the libblockdev/udisks vulnerability alone poses a serious risk, as it can independently grant root access on affected systems.

"Although it nominally requires 'allow_active' privileges, udisks ships by default on almost all Linux distributions, so nearly any system is vulnerable," said Qualys TRU senior manager Saeed Abbasi.

"Techniques to gain 'allow_active', including the PAM issue disclosed here, further negate that barrier. An attacker can chain these vulnerabilities for immediate root compromise with minimal effort."

The Qualys Threat Research Unit (TRU), which discovered and reported both flaws, has also developed proof-of-concept exploits and successfully targeted CVE-2025-6019 to get root privileges on Ubuntu, Debian, Fedora, and openSUSE Leap 15 systems.

One of the first things you'll notice is the redesigned interface across all editors, offering a more intuitive and user-friendly layout. To explore the new look, simply switch to the 'Modern Light' or 'Modern Dark' theme via View → Interface Theme.



The PDF Editor receives significant upgrades to streamline your workflow. You can now co-edit PDF forms in real time, easily rearrange pages using drag-and-drop in the thumbnails panel, and duplicate pages with a simple Ctrl + C / Ctrl + V.

AI features are also stepping in — enjoy automatic text extraction from PDFs, and smarter macro and formula automation in spreadsheets.

The Document Editor now includes a quick-access button for paragraph borders, improved Content Controls with better change tracking, and support for custom buttons via plugins.

TuxCare introduces ELS for Red Hat Enterprise Linux 7

TuxCare, a leader in open source security, has announced the launch of its Endless Lifecycle Support (ELS) for Red Hat Enterprise Linux 7. This cost-effective, precision-tailored solution enables organisations to maintain secure RHEL 7 environments well beyond the official end-of-life date.



The new ELS offering delivers ongoing patches for high and critical severity vulnerabilities for as long as needed. It provides a vendor-supported path forward without requiring the significant expense of both an active RHEL subscription and Red Hat's Extended Lifecycle Support.

"TuxCare's goal is to cost-effectively keep organisations free from the resulting unpatched vulnerabilities and compliance gaps that come with the EOL of RHEL 7," said Michael Canavan, chief revenue officer at TuxCare. "This new Endless Lifecycle Support for RHEL 7 removes the potentially high costs and worries that would otherwise stand as a notable hurdle in many enterprises. After all, there's little other choice but to upgrade to a supported version or switch to another alternative. This ELS quickly and efficiently puts an organisation in charge of their next moves instead of outside forces."

Kali Linux 2025.2 released with 13 new tools

The second Kali Linux release of the year, Kali Linux 2025.2, is now available, featuring 13 new tools and major upgrades to its car hacking toolkit. This release introduces several UI refinements and usability improvements. Major